

August 2026

Dear Beau Lafayette,

I've worked in Lamorinda long enough to recognize a Branagh home on sight, and 31 Sandy Court caught my attention the moment it came to market. The combination of a three-home cul-de-sac setting, a .65-acre lot with its own vineyard, and the kind of interior updates that actually hold up to scrutiny is genuinely rare at any price point in Orinda. When the listing came off the market after 32 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out.

Thirty-two days is close to the edge of the window where buyer psychology starts to shift, and in a home priced at \$2,895,000, perception matters enormously. My read on what happened is that the listing had strong bones but left several of the most compelling parts of this property underexplored in how it was positioned and distributed. The Branagh pedigree, the private vineyard, the cul-de-sac setting, the primary suite with its fireplace and spa bath - these aren't just nice-to-have features, they are the reasons a buyer at this level chooses one home over another. A standard MLS approach tends to mention those details and move on. At this price, buyers need to feel them before they make the drive.

I've put together a packet that walks through what I believe contributed to the outcome, how this home compares to the Orinda market right now, and what a relaunch strategy built specifically for 31 Sandy Court could look like. It's not a pitch for a lower price - it's a blueprint for reaching the buyers who are genuinely right for this home.

If you're already working with a real estate agent toward a new listing, please consider this a professional courtesy and feel free to set it aside. If you're not, I'd welcome a conversation whenever the timing feels right for you - no pressure, just a chance to look at the numbers together.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

31 Sandy Ct

Orinda, CA 94563

4.0 Beds · 4 Baths · 3,345 Sq Ft · Orinda

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 31 Sandy Ct

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Branagh-Built Retreat on a Private Cul-de-Sac - and a Listing That Left the Best Parts Untold

31 Sandy Court has the fundamentals that Orinda buyers at the \$2.9 million level are specifically looking for. A Branagh Development build signals quality before anyone walks through the door. The .65-acre lot, vineyard, hot tub, and expansive turf give the outdoor spaces a resort quality that is genuinely uncommon. Inside, soaring ceilings, a chef's kitchen open to the family room, a primary suite with a fireplace, and a spa-like renovated primary bath deliver the kind of lifestyle that justifies a premium - engineered hardwood, updated glass stair railings, and a dedicated office round out a home that is fully ready for a family to move in and not think twice.

The listing history doesn't reflect a problem with the home. It reflects a strategy that treated a distinctive property like a standard inventory listing. At 32 days on market without a sale, this home was approaching the point where buyer hesitation becomes self-reinforcing. The Branagh name, the private vineyard, the cul-de-sac privacy, and the spa-caliber primary suite were all mentioned in the listing description - but in a market where buyers researching \$2.9 million homes are comparing obsessively online before they ever schedule a showing, mentioning these features is not the same as selling them. The distribution and the media didn't build the case that the home itself absolutely supports.

\$2,895,000

List Price

\$865/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch for 31 Sandy Court needs to do one thing above all else: give the right buyer the visual and narrative depth to understand what makes this property singular before they visit. The Branagh pedigree, the private outdoor living environment, and the cul-de-sac setting are not features - they are the story. The strategy needs to lead with that story and put it in front of the specific buyers who are actively looking for it.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: The Branagh Premium Was Named, Not Sold

At \$865/sqft, 31 Sandy Court sits squarely in the architectural tier of the Orinda market, where buyers expect to understand exactly what they are paying for relative to other options. The listing description acknowledged the Branagh pedigree and the home's quality in general terms, but buyers comparing carefully at this price point need more than a name drop. The refined millwork, soaring ceilings, and spa-caliber primary suite are the specific reasons this home commands a premium over a standard updated Orinda listing - and each of those details deserved its own visual and narrative treatment. Without that depth, a well-informed buyer shopping \$2.9 million in Orinda will second-guess the number rather than feel confident in it.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk through every detail of a home like this from anywhere, on their own time - so the millwork, the ceiling volumes, and the primary suite aren't described, they're experienced. Buyers who've already walked the home virtually arrive at showings ready to decide.

Friction #2: The Outdoor Story Was Undersold at a Critical Price Point

A private vineyard, a hot tub, entertaining patios, and a half-acre-plus of usable turf on a cul-de-sac lot are not features you find in standard Orinda inventory. These outdoor spaces are a primary reason a buyer chooses 31 Sandy Court over a comparable home on a smaller or more exposed lot - but standard ground photography and MLS listing angles rarely capture scale, setting, or the sense of privacy that makes a lot like this feel special. A buyer browsing online cannot tell the difference between a .65-acre sanctuary and a .35-acre backyard from a handful of ground-level photos. The lot's position at the end of a three-home cul-de-sac, the vineyard rows, the entertaining flow - these need to be shown, not summarized.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour uses aerial video to show lot position, setting, and the privacy of a home's placement in a way no ground photo can replicate - buyers see the scale of the vineyard, the cul-de-sac buffer, and the overall outdoor environment before they ever visit.

Friction #3: The Right Buyers Weren't Being Actively Found

A \$2,895,000 home in Orinda has a specific buyer profile - often a SF or East Bay professional or family that is actively researching Lamorinda before committing to a showing schedule, comparing schools, commute access, and lifestyle carefully. At 32 days on market without a sale, the distribution strategy was working on a passive model: get on the MLS and major portals, and wait for the right buyer to find it. In a market where the qualifying buyer pool at this price point is finite and highly informed, passive distribution is a narrow path. The buyers who were genuinely right for 31 Sandy Court - drawn by the Branagh quality, the outdoor spaces, the top-rated schools, and the BART proximity - needed to be reached where they are actively researching, not just encountered if they happened across the listing.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork runs geo-targeted digital campaigns that put homes like 31 Sandy Court directly in front of SF and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Orinda - reaching them before they've committed to another listing, not after.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	31 Sandy Ct	Orinda Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$865/sqft	Architectural / character tier: \$860–\$950/sqft
Lot / Setting	.65-acre private cul-de-sac lot, vineyard, turf, hot tub	Typical Orinda lot: .25–.40 acres, standard yard
Architectural Character	Branagh Development build, soaring ceilings, refined millwork	Standard updated inventory, builder-grade finishes
Premium Features	Renovated primary suite with fireplace and spa bath, chef's kitchen, dedicated office, Tesla charger	Standard primary suite, updated kitchen
HOA	None	Varies - \$0 to \$300+/mo depending on community

The verdict: At \$865/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$860-\$950/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$865/sqft, 31 Sandy Court is priced at the entry point of Orinda's architectural tier - a number this home's Branagh pedigree, oversized private lot, and renovated interiors genuinely support. The positioning is sound, but the strategy needed to do more work to close the gap between what the data says and what online buyers could actually see and feel. A relaunch that leads with the outdoor setting, the builder quality, and the depth of the interior updates puts the marketing in line with what the home is already delivering.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Build the Visual Case Before the First Showing

A Branagh home with a private vineyard, soaring ceilings, and a spa-caliber primary suite is not a property that photographs like standard Orinda inventory - and it shouldn't be marketed like it. The visual package for 31 Sandy Court needs to capture scale, light, and the quality of the build in a way that gives online buyers the confidence to schedule a showing rather than move on to the next listing. BrightWork's Sky Tour and 3D Matterport give buyers the aerial perspective on the lot and the interior walkthrough that standard photography simply doesn't deliver. Buyers who arrive having already experienced the home are buyers who are ready to move.

Pillar II - Reach the Buyer Before They Find Something Else

The buyers who are right for 31 Sandy Court are not waiting to stumble across it on the MLS. They are professionals and families in San Francisco and the East Bay who are actively researching Orinda right now - comparing commute times to BART, reviewing school ratings, and building a mental shortlist. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns put this home in front of those buyers while they are still in the research phase, before they have committed to another listing or another neighborhood. Passive distribution assumes the right buyer finds you. Active distribution makes sure they do.

Pillar III - Tell the Cul-de-Sac Story, Not Just the Square Footage

The privacy of a three-home cul-de-sac, the rhythm of a working vineyard, the hot tub at sunset, the turf for kids and dogs - these are the things a buyer at \$2.9 million is actually buying, and they don't fit in a bullet point. The marketing for a relaunch of 31 Sandy Court needs to lead with the lifestyle and let the specifications follow. BrightWork's listing narrative and Zillow Showcase placement are built to tell that story where the most qualified buyers are already looking - turning a scroll into a click, and a click into a conversation.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Ben Olsen | (925) 255-9727 | ben@brightworkrealty.com | brightworkrealty.com

Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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